Duygu Demiray

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Research interests

sentence processing, computational psycholinguistics, long-distance dependency resolution, pragmatic reasoning in LLMs

Education

University of Massachusetts, Amherst

PhD in Linguistics — September 2024 – Present
Advisor: Professor Brian Dillon.

University of California, Santa Cruz
MA in Linguistics — September 2022 – June 2024
Committee: Professor Matt Wagers, Professor Roumyana Pancheva, Assistant Professor Mia Gong.

Bogazici University — Istanbul, Turkeye
BA in Linguistics — September 2017 – July 2021
Advisor: Pavel Logacev.

Honors and scholarships

Fulbright Masters Scholarship — 2022-2024

Humanities Institute Award (UC Santa Cruz) — 2022

Publications

TO APPEAR V0 alternations in Turkish

Yanran Mou, **Duygu Demiray**.
Proceedings of the Workshop on Turkic and Languages in Contact with Turkic Vol. 10, 2027

Processing covert dependencies: Turkish wh-in-situ
Duygu Demiray, Matt Wagers.
Proceedings of the Workshop on Turkic and Languages in Contact with Turkic Vol. 10, 2026

NELS 55: Proceedings of the Fifty-Fifth Annual Meeting of the North East Lingusitic Society
Duygu Demiray, Nir Segal, Roger Liu
GLSA Publications

Research experience

How does discourse context modulate surprisal?

PI: Brian Dillon June 2026 – Present

Teaching experience

Teaching assistant, Department of Linguistics (UMass) Spring 2026

LINGUIST 201: How Language Works: Introduction to Linguistic Theory
Instructor: Seth Cable

Teaching assistant, Department of Linguistics (UMass) Fall 2025
LINGUIST 101: People and Their Languages
Instructor: Rajesh Bhatt

Teaching assistant, Department of Linguistics (UC Santa Cruz) Spring 2024
LING 171: Psycholinguistics I
Instructor: Matt Wagers

Industry experience

ICT Information Technologies Gebze, Turkey

Junior Software Engineer August 2021 – June 2022

- Developed and maintained production web applications using PHP (CodeIgniter), JavaScript, jQuery, SQL, and HTML.
- Implemented new features for insurance and vehicle-repair management systems used by business clients.
- Designed and optimized database queries supporting reporting, record tracking, and operational workflows.
- Collaborated with developers to troubleshoot issues and deliver software improvements.

Skills

Programming

Proficient in: R, Python
Familiar with: PHP, SQL, Javacsript

Languages
Turkish (native), English (advanced)

Service and outreach

NELS editor September 2022 – June 2024

One of three editors for the Proceedings of NELS 55.
s/lab September 2022 – June 2024

Organized and participated in a student-led reading group focusing on sentence processing at UC Santa Cruz. Invited outside speakers, both students and faculty, to give talks in person or over Zoom.

EquiL September 2022 – June 2024

Participated in a student-led group focusing on issues related to equality, diversity, and representation among linguistics graduate students. We organized wellness events, student-faculty workshops on improving graduate student wellness, and helped graduate students utilize various resources available within the department and across the campus.